

Grade 4 ELA Major Assessment Guide

Weekly integrated check-ins, end-of-novel projects, and quarterly writing process assessments

Assessment in OAO ELA should feel like a guided demonstration of reading, language, and writing growth. Each week, students complete a short integrated check-in showing grammar, morphology, spelling or word analysis, reading comprehension, and writing transfer from the current concept set. Each major novel or text unit ends with a project-based assessment rather than a traditional written test whenever possible. Each quarter also includes a substantial writing-process assignment.

Assessment Architecture

Assessment layer	Cadence	Purpose	Primary evidence
Weekly Check-In	Every instructional week	Verify transfer of weekly grammar, morphology, spelling/word analysis, reading, and writing concepts.	Short Canvas quiz plus one written or recorded response.
End-of-Novel / End-of-Text Project	After each core novel or major text unit	Let students show whole-text understanding through creative, oral, visual, multimedia, or performance-based work.	Project artifact, presentation/recording, source/text evidence, reflection.
Quarterly Writing Process Assignment	Four times per year	Guide students through brainstorm, plan, draft, revise, edit, and publish.	Draft checkpoints, revision evidence, final polished writing, reflection.
Portfolio / Year-End Synthesis	Final weeks	Show growth as reader, writer, speaker, and word scholar.	Curated samples, reflection, presentation, comparison, or multimedia product.

Weekly Integrated Check-In Template

Component	What students show	Suggested evidence / item types
Grammar and conventions	Students apply the weekly grammar/conventions concept in context, not as isolated recall only.	1 correction/edit item; 1 identification item; 1 sentence application item.
Morphology and vocabulary	Students analyze roots, affixes, base words, word families, and context clues from the week.	Word-part breakdown; choose meaning from context; use one vocabulary word in a meaningful sentence.
Spelling / word analysis	Students transfer the weekly pattern into reading and writing unfamiliar words.	Sort or decode 4-6 words; explain one spelling pattern; correct one misspelled word.
Reading comprehension	Students show the weekly What Good Readers Do skill with the assigned text.	Short excerpt question; cite one detail; summarize, infer, track perspective, theme, central idea, or claim.
Writing / RWM transfer	Students imitate, revise, or compose using the week's sentence/writing focus.	One RWM mimic sentence; one short response; one revision sentence showing the target skill.

Recommended Canvas format: 10-15 total points. Use 6-8 auto-graded or short constructed-response items plus 1 short written, audio, or video submission. The check-in should take about 20-30 minutes and should feel like a weekly transfer task, not a long test.

Grade 4 Weekly Check-In Map

Use this map to plan weekly Canvas check-ins. Each check-in should include one item or task from each skill column, with increasing independence across the year.

Weeks	Core text / unit	Weekly check-in focus	Writing process checkpoint or product
1-6	Mrs. Frisby and the Rats of NIMH	Setting/characters/problem, conflict, predictions, motivation, theme, affixes review, syllable division, verbs, sentence types, nouns.	Q1 narrative: seed ideas, plan, draft, revise, publish.
7-14	Anne of Green Gables	Narrator vs. perspective, character change, cause/effect, setting, theme, prefixes/root bases, schwa, verbs, possessives, clauses.	Realistic fiction: character voice, conflict, scenes, pacing, final draft.
15-19	Number the Stars + context	Background knowledge, danger inference, courage evidence, symbolism, historical fiction vs. history, roots, pronouns, contractions, homophones.	Q2 opinion writing: claim about courage/loyalty, reasons, evidence, conclusion.
20-25	Freedom Train / Harriet Tubman sources	Central idea, chronology, cause/effect, author perspective, relevant details, source comparison, prefixes, suffixes, academic vocabulary.	Q3 expository/research writing: question, notes, draft, elaborate, revise, present.
26-30	Prince Caspian	Fantasy setting, multiple groups of characters, leadership choices, theme, resolution, cumulative morphology, conjunctions, complex sentences, dialogue.	Literary analysis: character comparison, leadership claim, theme paragraph.
31-32	Year-end synthesis	Compare themes across texts, morphology review, grammar spiral, fluency and oral presentation.	Final project or portfolio reflection.

End-of-Novel and Major Text Assessments

These are designed as project-based assessments. Students should show whole-text comprehension, literary or informational analysis, and skill transfer without relying on a traditional written test as the main evidence.

Unit / weeks	Text or focus	Project-based assessment	Required evidence	Best-fit skills
1-6	Mrs. Frisby and the Rats of NIMH	Problem-Solver Dossier: students create a case file showing problem, rising action, character motivation, and theme.	Timeline; character motivation; theme evidence; final narrative reflection.	Plot; conflict; theme; narrative craft.
7-14	Anne of Green Gables	Character Growth Scrapbook: students build a visual and written record of Anne's perspective, choices, setting, and growth.	Before/after character evidence; setting connection; theme statement.	Perspective; character development; setting; theme.
15-19	Number the Stars	Courage and Historical Context Exhibit: students connect scenes from the novel to historical information and explain courage or loyalty.	Novel evidence; historical source detail; symbol explanation; oral/visual component.	Historical fiction; symbolism; source comparison; opinion claim.
20-25	Freedom Train	Harriet Tubman Research Museum Board: students organize biography evidence around central idea, chronology, cause/effect, and perspective.	Research notes; timeline; central idea; primary/secondary source comparison; presentation.	Informational text; biography; research; sources.
26-30	Prince Caspian	Leadership Council Presentation: students evaluate a leadership choice and explain how resolution reveals theme.	Claim; character comparison; theme evidence; creative council artifact.	Leadership choices; theme; character comparison.
31-32	Year-end	Virtue Across Books Showcase: students compare courage, loyalty, leadership, or growth across two or more texts.	Cross-text categories; evidence cards; presentation/reflection.	Compare themes; oral presentation; multimedia.

Quarterly Writing Assignments Using the Writing Process

Each quarter includes one major writing product. Weekly lessons may reduce normal skill volume during drafting and publishing weeks, but the weekly check-in still asks students to show how grammar, morphology, spelling, reading, and RWM work transfer into writing.

Stage	Canvas checkpoint	Expected student evidence
Brainstorm	Teacher video models idea generation and mentor-text connection.	Idea list, quickwrite, topic web, character/problem list, research question list, or claim possibilities.
Plan	Students organize before drafting.	Story arc, paragraph plan, source note organizer, claim-reason-evidence chart, or comparison matrix.
Draft	Students compose a complete first draft section by section.	Draft submitted in Canvas or digital writing tool; teacher/model checklist available.
Revise	Students improve meaning, organization, elaboration, voice, and evidence.	Revision checklist plus highlighted changed section; peer/adult feedback when available.
Edit	Students apply grammar, punctuation, capitalization, spelling, and morphology knowledge.	Editing checklist; corrected conventions; attention to weekly grammar/spelling transfer.
Publish / Present	Students create final polished work and reflect.	Final product plus reflection on one improvement and one skill carried forward.

Quarterly Writing Map

Quarter	Writing product	Primary process emphasis	Notes for Canvas
Q1	Narrative writing: problem-based story inspired by Mrs. Frisby	Collect seed ideas, plan conflict, draft rising action, revise dialogue/description, publish.	Weeks 1-6 carry process checkpoints.
Q2	Opinion essay: courage, loyalty, or responsibility in Number the Stars	Choose claim, reasons, evidence, elaboration, conclusion, revise and publish.	Weeks 15-19 carry the main process arc.
Q3	Expository/research project: Harriet Tubman / Freedom Train	Research question, notes from multiple sources, organized sections, presentation.	Weeks 20-25 include research, drafting, publishing, and oral presentation.
Q4	Literary analysis / comparison: theme, leadership, or character growth	Plan comparison categories, draft analysis, revise for evidence and voice, present.	Weeks 26-32 build toward synthesis.

Common Rubric for ELA Major Assessments

Criterion	Developing	Secure	Strong
Integrated weekly skills	Shows partial understanding of grammar, morphology, spelling, reading, or writing skills.	Correctly applies most weekly skills with grade-appropriate independence.	Applies all weekly skills accurately and explains choices or patterns.
Reading understanding	Retells loosely or answers without evidence.	Shows accurate understanding and uses at least one relevant detail.	Uses precise evidence and explains how it supports the answer.
Language and word study	Recognizes some rules or word parts but transfers inconsistently.	Applies the week's conventions, spelling, and morphology in context.	Uses word study to improve reading, spelling, vocabulary, and writing precision.
Writing craft and process	Writes with limited organization or revision.	Writes clearly and uses the assigned process/checklist.	Revises purposefully for structure, voice, evidence, and conventions.
Project communication	Product is incomplete or mostly summary.	Product communicates key understanding clearly and creatively.	Product shows synthesis, thoughtful choices, and polished presentation.

Canvas Setup Recommendations

- Create one recurring Weekly Check-In assignment shell and duplicate it each week with the current grammar, morphology, spelling, reading, and writing targets.
- Use short teacher videos before project and writing checkpoints so students understand the purpose of each step.
- For end-of-novel projects, require at least three pieces of text evidence, but allow students to present understanding through a visual, oral, multimedia, dramatic, or creative product.
- For quarterly writing, grade process checkpoints lightly and reserve the larger score for the polished product and reflection.
- Keep rubrics student-facing and concise: understanding, evidence, language skills, writing/process, and presentation quality.

Source basis: grade-level ELA scope and sequence files, the OAO ELA design summary, and Florida B.E.S.T. ELA standards exports provided for this planning task.